

SE_07 Self-Assessment and Reflection

Essay

Before I took this module I didn't do much documentation in my code if any. I had never created comprehensive documentation or thought it was important to have any. My goal was to learn how to create proper documentation for my current project and any future projects.

I learned what documentation is for and how it should be used. I used to think documentation was just something you have to do. Now I understand that good documentation is what makes software usable and maintainable. I learned how to write different types of documentation for different audiences. Since you would not tell a developer the same thing you would tell someone who is just starting out or just wants to test the project. I also learned that there are different types of documentation, not just READMEs. There are procedural (how-to guides), conceptual (high-level explanations), reference (API docs), and contributor guides. Each serves a different purpose, and good projects need all of them.

The hardest challenge for me was always documenting everything since I was definitely not used to it. I would instead usually just code a bit and when I am done for the day or this period, I would either go through what I did and document it or make sure it's simple enough and does not need any comments or does not need to be added to like the README or anything of the sorts. Also creating diagrams was a bit challenging since I was always used to just drawing or filling in the blank but having to use dbdiagram.io did make it somewhat easy after understanding how to use it.

What I am happy about in this project is that the main README is very well put together and looks good and did not take too much time to create, having an AI help me with it was definitely a big help since it could speed up the process a bit but I made sure I understood everything that was put in it and did changes I thought were necessary. The contributing.md file is also very well done and I was also helped a bit with AI but the process of it was simple and I understood everything I put in it. The clean_code.md was a file necessary for one of my assessments but I also think it would help if any contributor wanted to join the project since then that would make sure they follow the same principles I followed. Swagger was also a very big help since it made the API endpoints testable for people right in their browsers. I also added a backend README and frontend README to make things simple.

I used AI for a lot of things but mostly to help me make sure everything is good and looks good and can be improved on what I had. I did also have it help me in code commenting and make sure that what I had commented actually fits with what I am commenting on. Also made sure I understood everything I put in my project and can fully explain anything I am asked about in the project.

This module helped me a lot in understanding why documentation is necessary and I should always include it in my future projects. The most valuable skill was learning to think about my audience. Who will read this? What do they need to know? These questions helped me write clearer documentation. I am very happy with what I have learned and what I was able to implement in my project.

I think I achieved the high end of level 1 or the beginnings of level 2 with what I have in my project since I have, clear, accessible writing with step-by-step instructions, three main audiences identified (users, contributors, API consumers), all required documentation types included, clear diagrams (ER diagram, architecture diagram), git history shows iterations and testing.